

Enterprise Knowledge Base - VPN Connectivity

Purpose: Standard operating procedure for VPN incidents handled by Service Desk.

Scenario 1 – VPN Cannot Connect

Symptoms

Connection timeout, authentication failed, unable to reach gateway.

Possible Causes

No internet, VPN service stopped, expired password, firewall restriction.

Validation Steps

Confirm internet works, ping public site, verify VPN client service, confirm credentials.

Resolution Steps

Restart VPN client, reboot system, reconnect. If Gateway-1 fails, disconnect completely and connect using Gateway-2/Secondary VPN profile. Update VPN client if outdated.

Escalate When

Both VPN gateways fail or gateway unavailable enterprise-wide.

Scenario 2 – VPN Disconnects Frequently

Symptoms

VPN drops every few minutes.

Possible Causes

Unstable Wi-Fi, ISP packet loss, sleep mode, outdated client.

Validation Steps

Check Wi-Fi signal, continuous ping, review VPN logs.

Resolution Steps

Use wired connection if possible, disable power saving, reconnect, reinstall VPN client.

Escalate When

Persistent disconnects after reinstall.

Scenario 3 – Connected but Applications Not Working

Symptoms

VPN shows Connected but intranet, file share or SAP inaccessible.

Possible Causes

DNS issue, routing issue, split tunnel policy, expired session.

Validation Steps

Check assigned corporate IP, run ipconfig, nslookup internal host, ping internal server.

Resolution Steps

Disconnect/reconnect VPN, flush DNS, renew IP, verify correct VPN profile, restart affected application.

Escalate When

Internal routing issue or multiple users affected.

Scenario 4 – MFA Failure During VPN Login

Symptoms

MFA prompt never arrives or approval rejected.

Possible Causes

Authenticator issue, time sync, expired registration.

Validation Steps

Verify MFA registration and mobile connectivity.

Resolution Steps

Approve through alternate factor. Re-register authenticator after identity validation. Security team may issue temporary bypass if approved.

Escalate When

MFA backend outage or identity cannot be verified.

Scenario 5 – Certificate Error

Symptoms

Certificate invalid or expired.

Possible Causes

Expired machine/user certificate.

Validation Steps

Check certificate validity and endpoint compliance.

Resolution Steps

Renew certificate through endpoint management or Intune/SCCM, restart VPN services.

Escalate When

Certificate enrollment fails.

Scenario 6 – Validate Successful VPN Connection

Symptoms

User wants confirmation VPN is operational.

Possible Causes

Routine validation.

Validation Steps

Verify VPN status 'Connected', assigned internal IP, access intranet, open shared drive, RDP/SAP/ServiceNow internal URL, ping internal hostname.

Resolution Steps

If all validations succeed, incident can be closed with user confirmation.

Escalate When

Any internal resource remains inaccessible.